

Bus Network Resilience in London and Los Angeles

A Comparative Study of Bus Network Resilience Under Disruption

How do bus networks in London and Los Angeles respond to disruptions, and what insights can we gain about their resilience?

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Networks used

- Compare the bus transportation networks of London and Los Angeles
 - Analyze the network and its resilience
- Networks are modeled as graphs where:
 - Nodes represent bus stops
 - Edges represent bus routes connecting consecutive stops

Filtered for bus stops only!

London Bus Network

NODES: 21373 | **EDGES:** 27042

Average Degree: 2.53

Average Clustering Coefficient: 0.0159

Global Clustering Coefficient: 0.0313

Average Path Length: 30.32

Diameter: 97

Source: <https://transitfeeds.com/p/traveline/1033>

Los Angeles Bus Network

NODES: 12007 | **EDGES:** 12957

Average Degree: 2.16

Average Clustering Coefficient: 0.0119

Global Clustering Coefficient: 0.0240

Average Path Length: 61.33

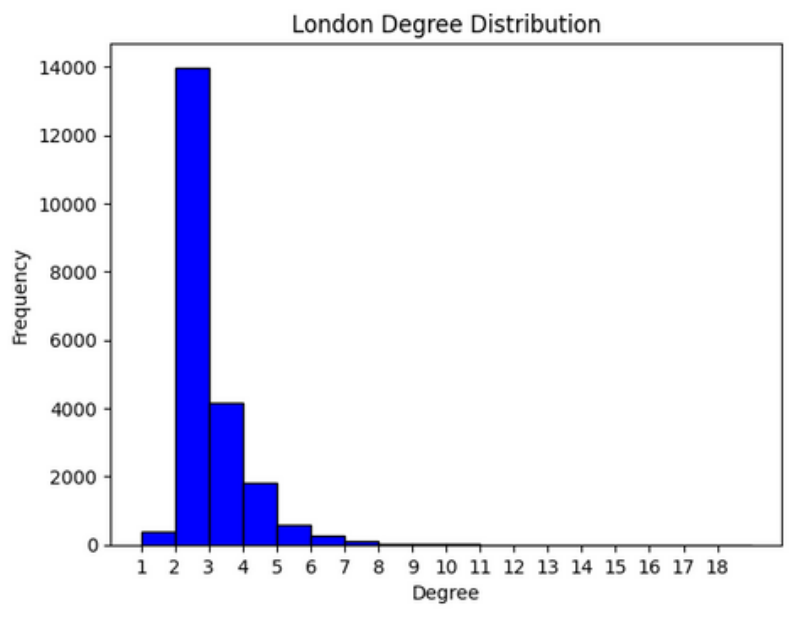
Diameter: 197

Source: <https://transitfeeds.com/p/la-metro/184>

LONDON

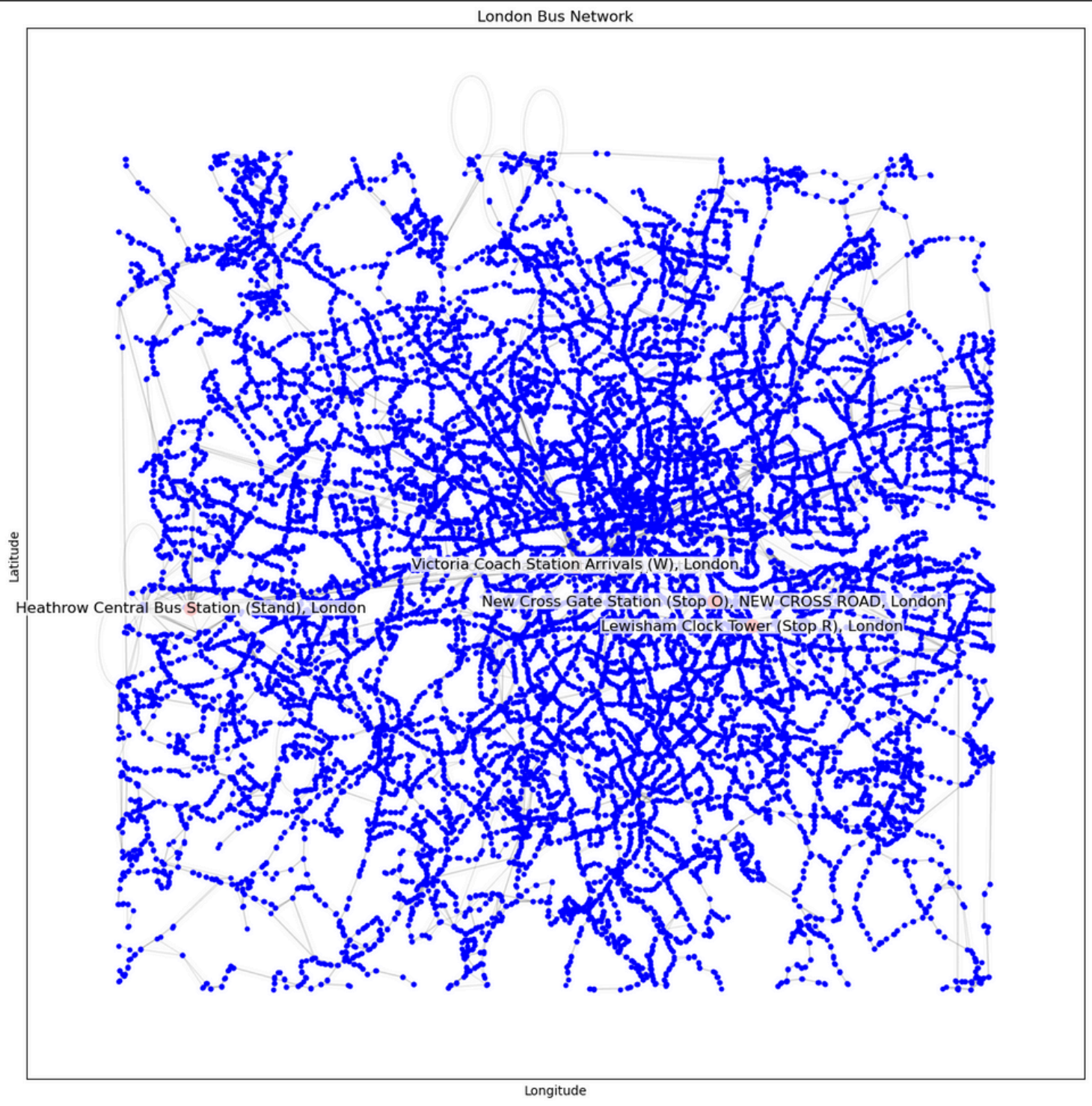
Network Statistics

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Most Important Stations

STATION NAME	BETWEENNESS CENTRALITY
Victoria Coach Station Arrivals (W)	0.333009
Victoria Coach Station (NE)	0.317163
Heathrow Central Bus Station (Stand)	0.181231
New Cross Gate Station (Stop O)	0.162313
Lewisham Clock Tower (Stop R)	0.149888

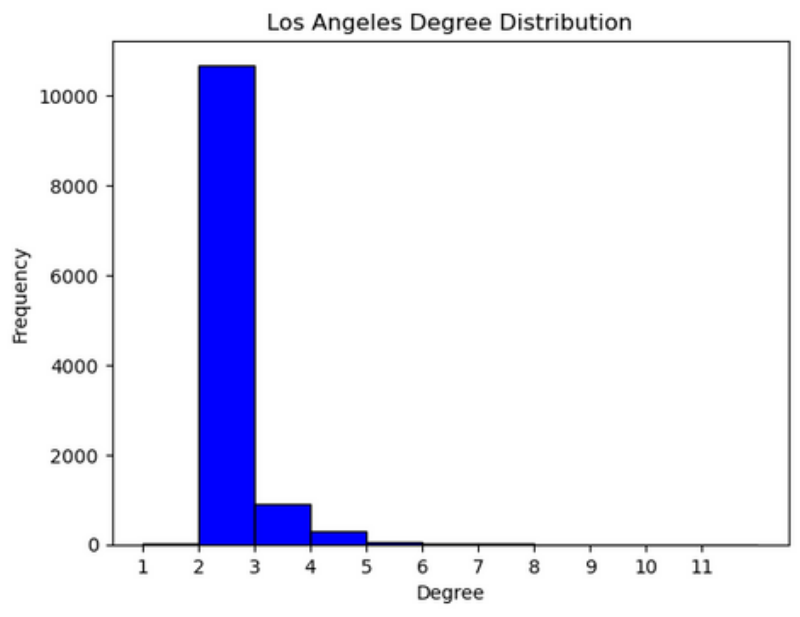


Note: "Victoria Coach Station (NE)" is right under "Victoria Coach Station Arrivals (W)"

LOS ANGELES

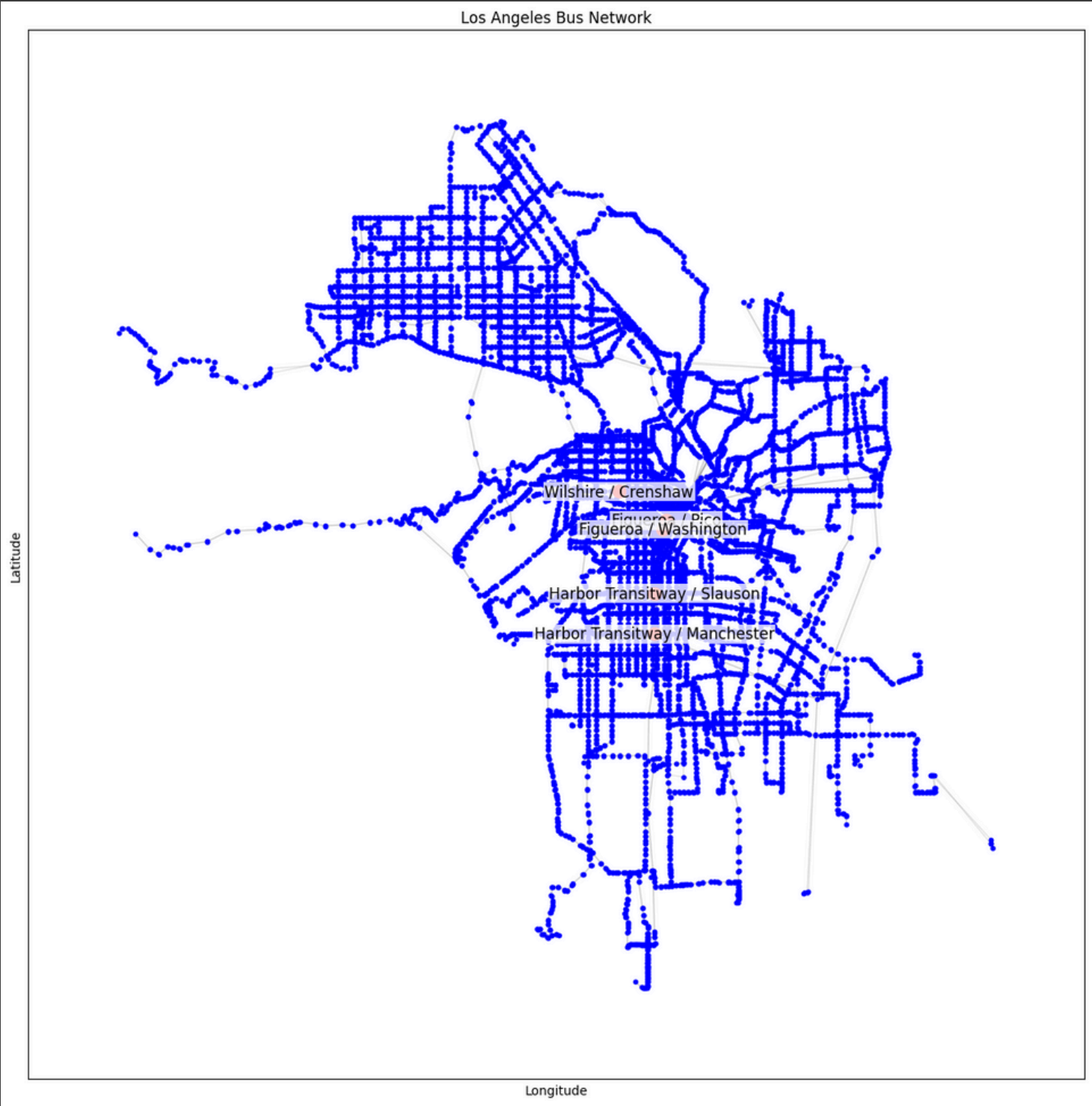
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Most Important Stations

STATION NAME	BETWEENNESS CENTRALITY
Harbor Transitway / Slauson	0.221865
Figueroa / Pico	0.214108
Harbor Transitway / Manchester	0.208528
Figueroa / Washington	0.201803
Wilshire / Crenshaw	0.199689



Research Question

How resilient are the London and Los Angeles bus networks to random and targeted failures?

Point of Failure

- Point at which the network's performance experiences a significant breakdown due to node removal
- Threshold where the network transitions from functioning efficiently to being disrupted

1. Simulate targeted and random station removal

- Remove stations randomly to simulate unexpected disruptions
 - 3 repetitions and take the average of the results
- Remove stations based on betweenness centrality to simulate targeted disruptions on most important stations

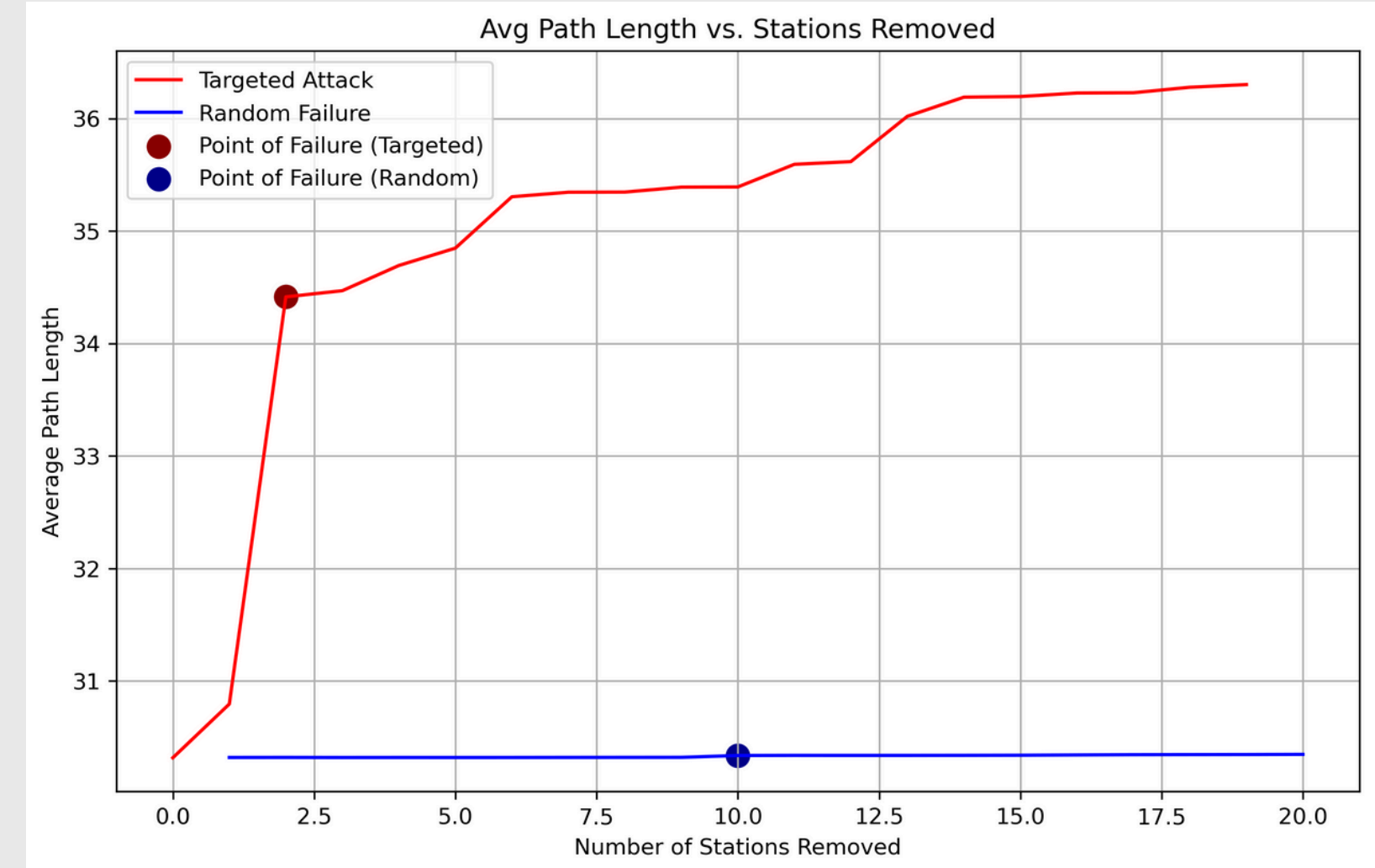
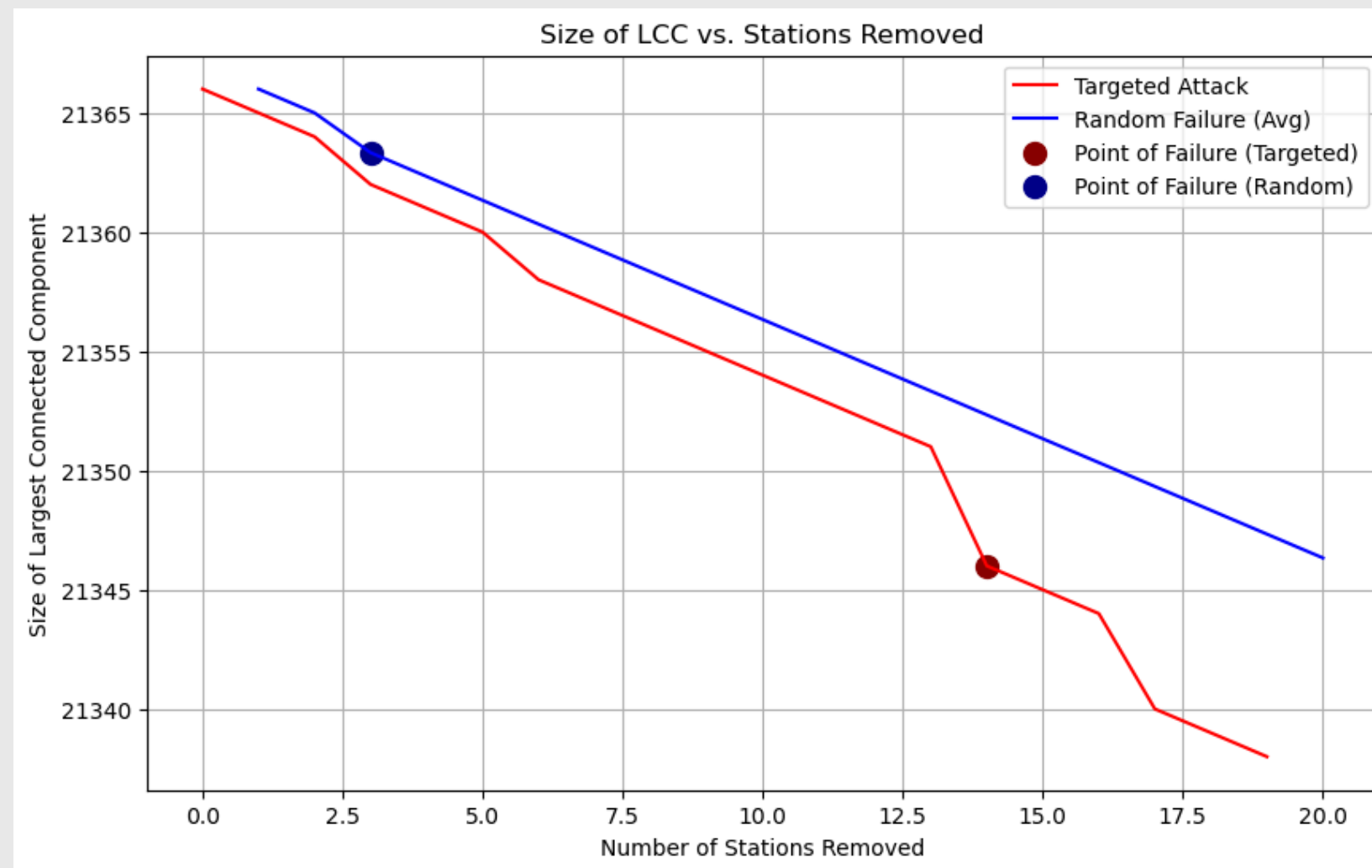
2. Calculate LCC size and the APL

- **LCC Size** (Largest Connected Component):
 - Measures the size of the largest remaining part of the network as stops are removed
- **APL** (Average Path Length):
 - Tracks how efficiently stops remain connected

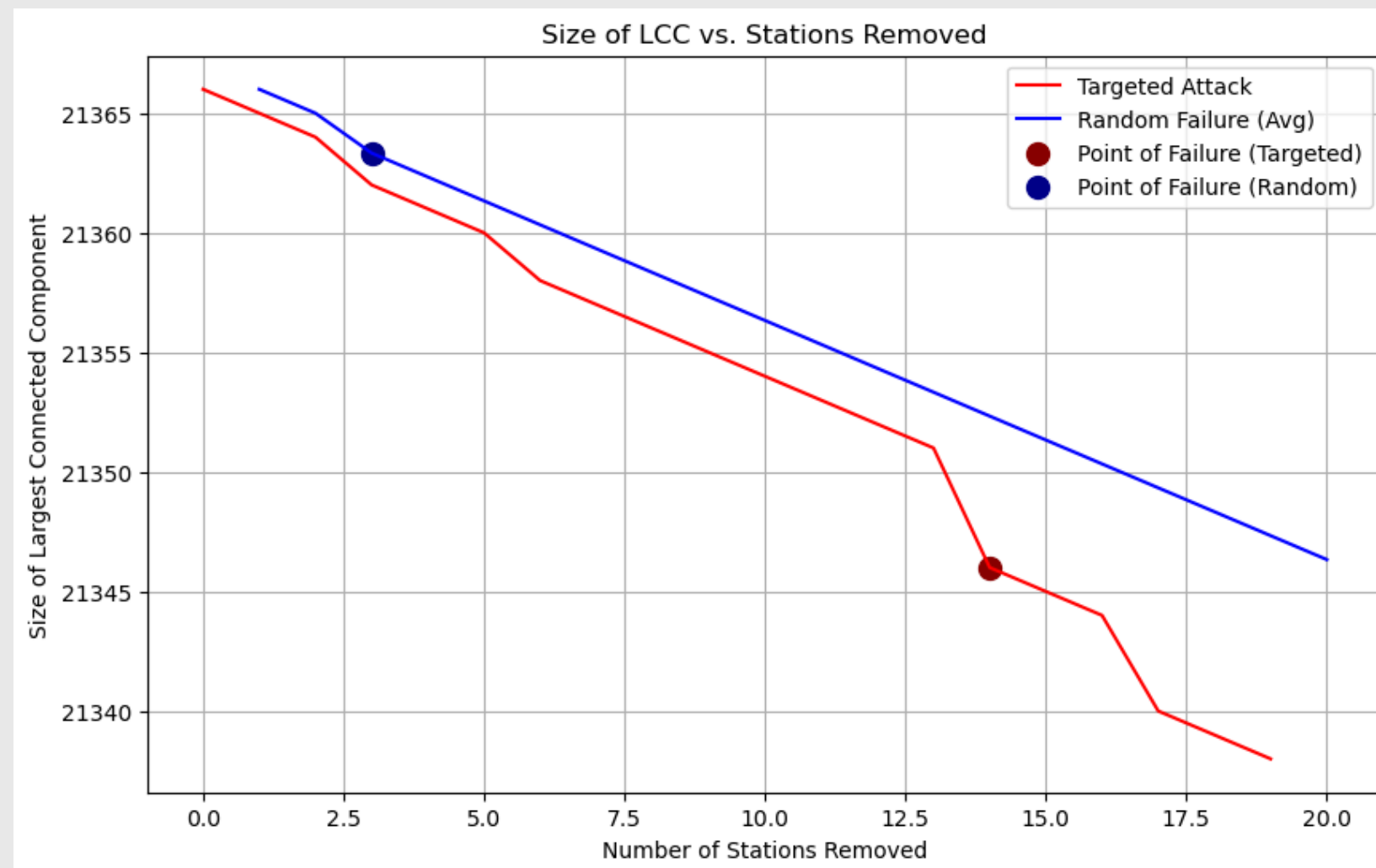
3. Compare results and make conclusions

- Identify which network (London vs. LA) is more resilient and why
- Discuss how network design impacts overall robustness

Analysis - London



Analysis – London

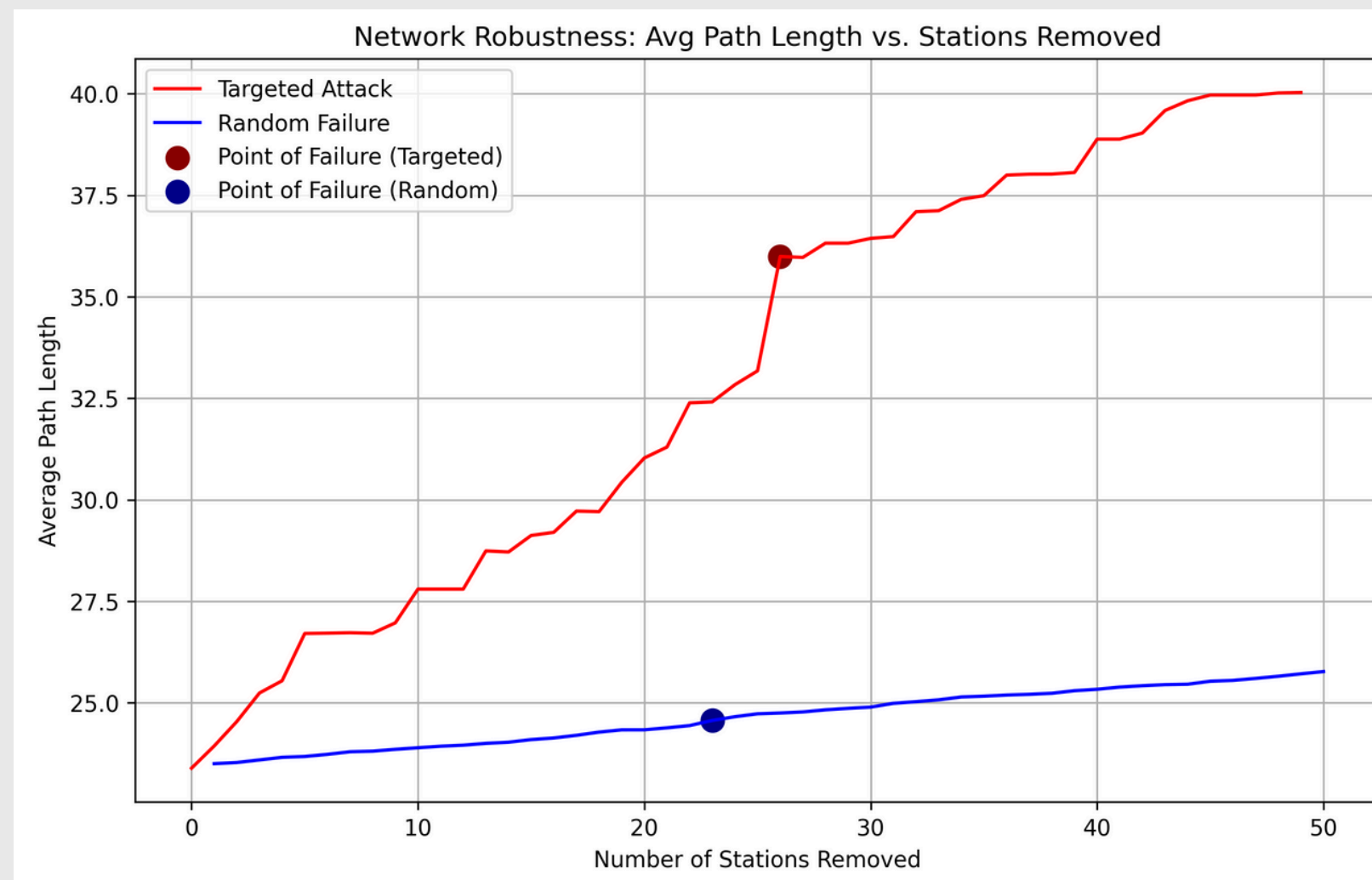


Size of LCC vs. Stations Removed

- Shows how the LCC shrinks as stops are removed
- Targeted Attacks:**
 - Targeted removals cause a significant drop earlier
 - Shows the network's vulnerability when critical nodes are removed intentionally
- Random Failures:**
 - Removing random stops causes a more gradual decrease in LCC size than the targeted attack
 - Due to its definition, point of failure occurs early on as it only experiences a significant change then, but afterwards the decrease is very slow and gradual

Targeted attacks break apart the network quicker because high-betweenness stops are important for connectivity

Analysis – London

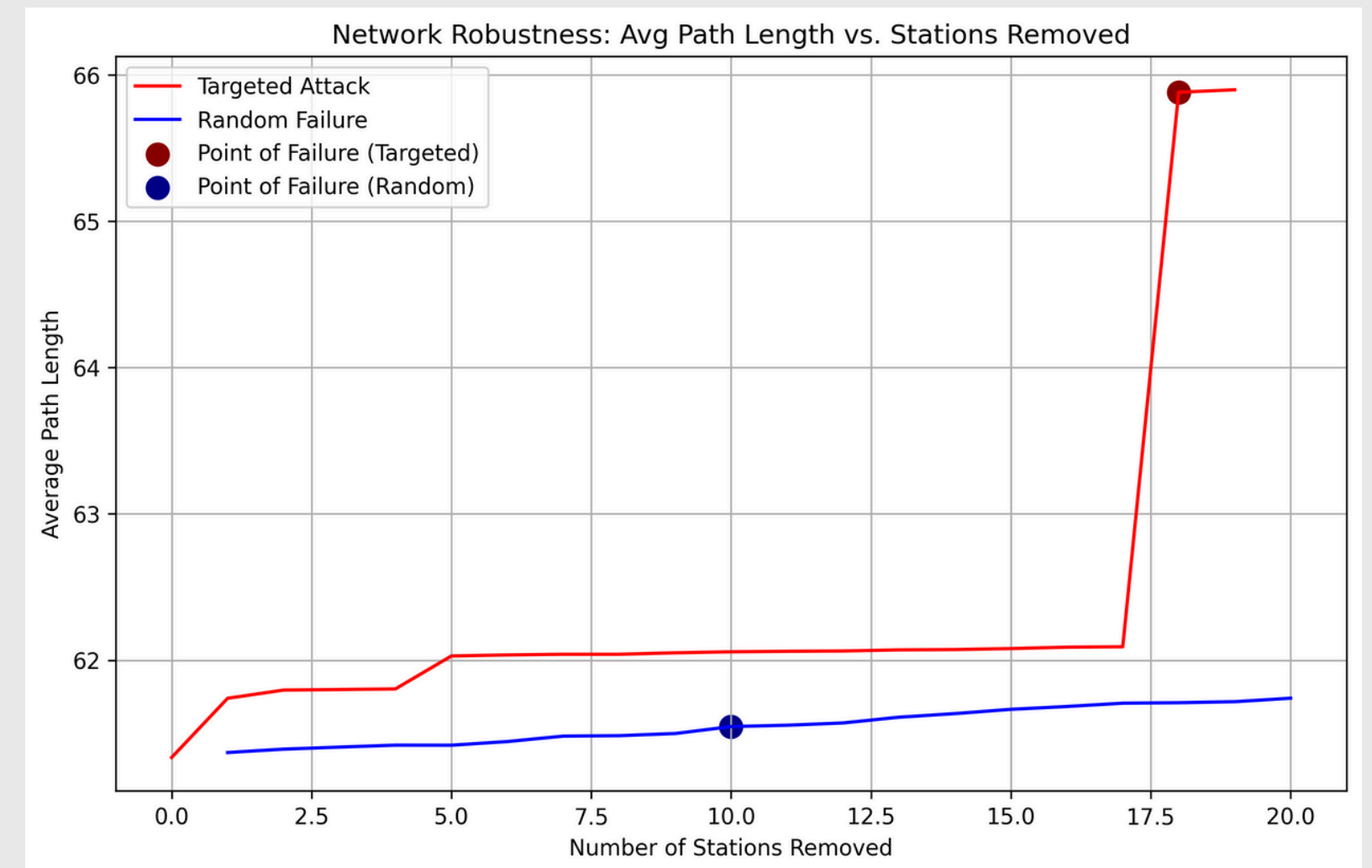
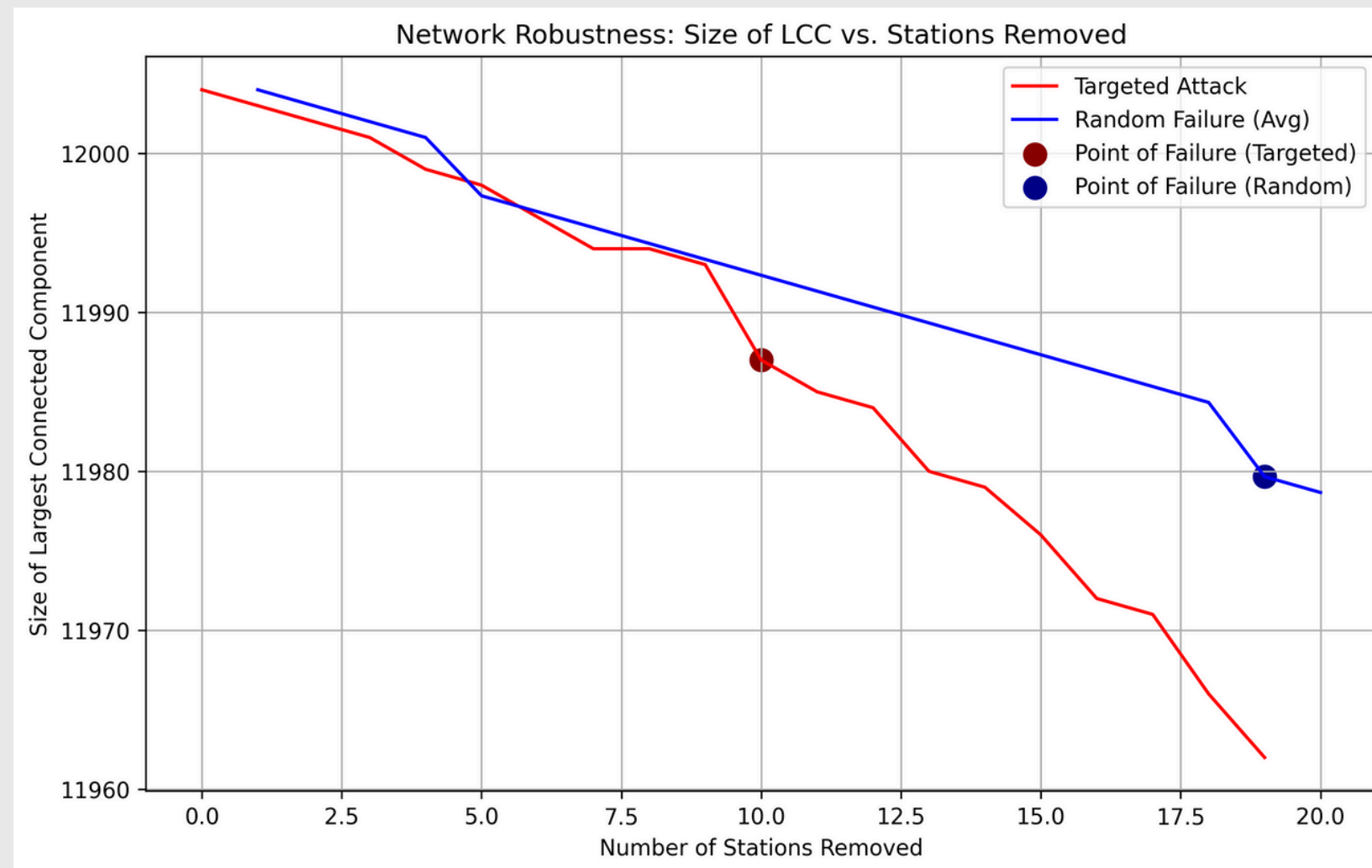


APL vs. Stations Removed

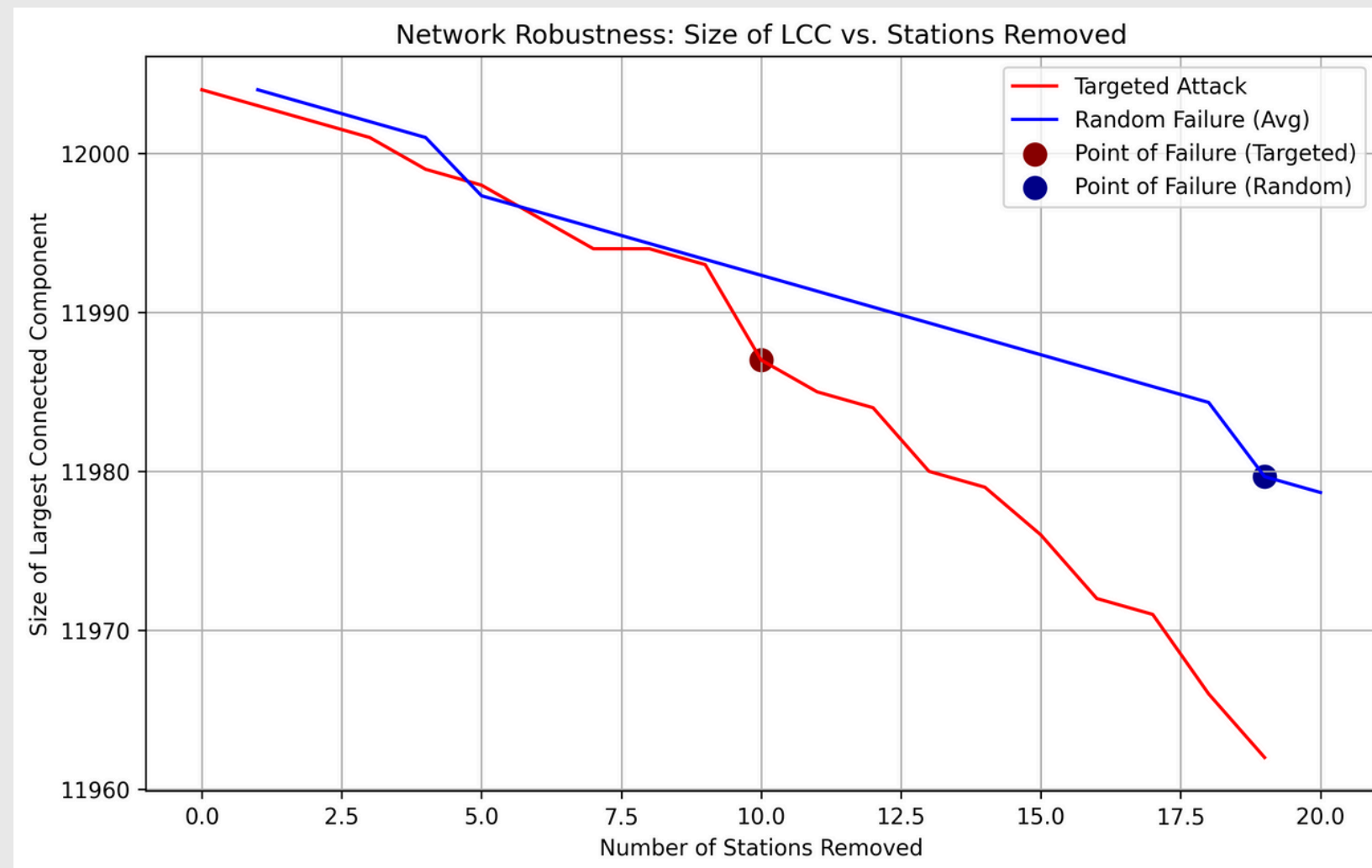
- Shows how the APL increases as stops are removed
- **Targeted Attacks:**
 - APL increases quickly, then jumps at the point of failure (~25 stops removed)
 - Overall, the APL increases quite significantly, showing loss of travel efficiency in the network
- **Random Failures:**
 - APL increases very slowly as random nodes are removed
 - Point of failure shows only a minor disruption
 - Random removals have minimal impact on the APL, which shows resilience to random disruptions

Targeted attacks cause a loss of efficiency and random failures have a much smaller impact, with only gradual increases in path length

Analysis - Los Angeles



Analysis – Los Angeles

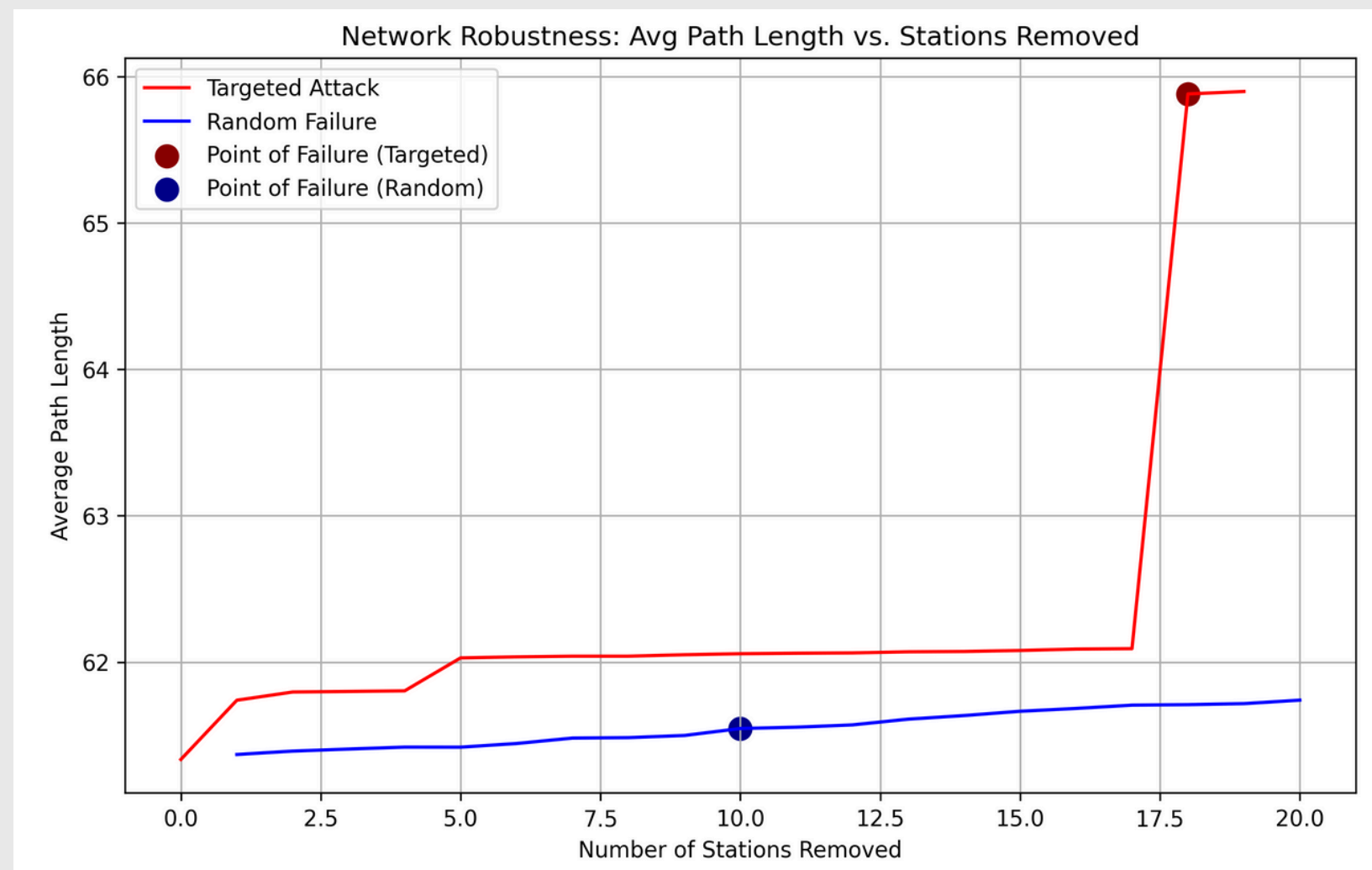


Size of LCC vs. Stations Removed

- Shows how the LCC decreases as stops are removed
- **Targeted Attacks:**
 - LCC size drops gradually after just a small number of critical stations are removed
 - Point of failure (~10 stations) shows where the network begins to fragment more quickly
- **Random Failures:**
 - LCC size decreases gradually as random stops are removed
 - The point of failure (~18 stations) occurs later

LA network seems dependent on critical hubs
Under targeted attacks, network falls apart quicker. Random failures have a smaller, gradual impact, showing redundancy in the network

Analysis - Los Angeles



APL vs. Stations Removed

- Shows how the APL increases as stops are removed
- **Targeted Attacks:**
 - APL remains relatively stable at first but spikes at the point of failure (~10 stations removed)
 - Network becomes more inefficient when critical stops are removed
- **Random Failures:**
 - APL increases slowly, showing that random node removal does not significantly disrupt the network's efficiency

Targeted Attacks cause a sharp increase in APL. Random Failures only have a minor effect on APL, suggesting that the network maintains its efficiency well

Results

London

- Overall more resilient to disruptions
- Handles random failures well, showing slow and gradual loss in connectivity and efficiency
- Targeted attacks cause quicker fragmentation and loss in travel efficiency

London's network is more robust overall, but still relies on critical stops for maintaining good connectivity

Los Angeles

- Less resilient, especially under targeted attacks
- Network breaks down quicker when critical stops are removed
- Random failures cause some disruptions, but the network remains less efficient overall

Los Angeles' network is more fragile under targeted attacks due to its reliance on critical hubs and lack of alternative routes

Research Question Answer

- **London is more resilient overall**
 - It handles random failures well, with gradual decreases in connectivity and efficiency
 - Targeted attacks on critical stops cause more and quicker disruption
- **Los Angeles is less resilient under targeted attacks**
 - Network breaks down quicker when important stops are removed
 - Network remains less efficient than London's network overall

London's network has a stronger overall structure, staying mostly connected under disruptions. However, its efficiency drops quicker, as seen in the sharp increase in APL

In contrast, Los Angeles fragments faster losing connectivity earlier, but its APL remains relatively stable due to the network's already lower base efficiency

Limitations and Further Research

Limitations

- **Unweighted Network Assumption**
 - The analysis treats all connections between stops as equal
 - Real-world bus networks have weights like travel time, frequency of buses, or passenger capacity, which can greatly affect resilience
- **Static Network Representation**
 - The network does not account for time-dependent changes like, peak vs. off-peak hours, bus delays, or dynamic disruptions (multiple failures happening sequentially)
- **Lack of Passenger Data**
 - The importance of stops is determined based on centrality measures, but real-world importance depends on passenger flow
- **Computational complexity**
 - APL as a comparative measure does not work best for large, dense networks like London because it's very computationally expensive

Further Research

- **Weighted Network Analysis**
 - Incorporate edge weights like travel time, frequency, or passenger volume to study how weighted disruptions affect resilience
- **Edge Disruptions**
 - We focused on node (stop) removal, but routes (edges) can also fail due to traffic, construction, or other disruptions
- **Compare more cities**
 - Expand the analysis to include cities with different urban layouts and public transport designs
- **Improving Network Design**
 - Propose ways to make public transport networks more resilient, reduce dependence on important stops and optimize stop placements to improve connectivity and efficiency
- **Choosing metrics**
 - Explore and implement alternative comparative metrics to gain better insights into network performance

Thank you!
for your time

